

Chapter 44-1

The mechanical voice continued to ramble on as usual.

[Due to the host using illegal means when obtaining luck points, such as exposing personal information, three luck points will be deducted this time. The host's current luck points are fifty-eight. (Emmm, for a moment I don't know whether you succeeded or failed. Forget it, since Little System has already found you, you should start the additional side quest!) The misfortune points are four. Please work hard to complete the additional tasks, host. Otherwise, next time, the host might receive punishment from the misfortune system.]

[PS: You know, Little System doesn't want to punish you. Another PS: Please stop self-exposing! If you continue like this, even immortals can't save you! Yet another PS: Little System advises you not to be OOC¹ anymore.]

[Forget it, you're already so OOC that Little System's advice is meaningless. Host, you must work hard! Accumulating such high luck points in less than a month is truly unprecedented talent. Little System is proud of you! Cheering for you! To send us scumbag women back to their happy old home², let's work hard together!]

[Oh right, are you busy right now?! Host, please work hard! According to detection, your target's emotions are currently unstable. Your misfortune points are continuously increasing. Eek! It's reached seven! Wuu wuu wuu, so scary. Host, you must keep going!]

This strange, cutesy mechanical voice had just finished when another serious mechanical voice sounded.

[Ding dong! Detection shows that the host's misfortune points have accumulated to sixteen, triggering level two punishment. Punishment content: heart pain. Duration: five minutes.]

[Misfortune point accumulation list as follows:

Silence angering Xu Qingzhu: 2

Ignoring Xu Qingzhu: 5

Deceiving Xu Qingzhu: 6

Making Xu Qingzhu cry: 6

Total: 19

PS: All interpretation rights belong to the misfortune system. If you have differing opinions, please... hold them back.]

The strange mechanical voice ended.

Liang Shi felt as if something had struck her heart hard. The physical pain instantly pulled her consciousness back.

She clutched her chest and collapsed onto the sofa. The moment she turned her face, she discovered Xu Qingzhu was crying.

Liang Shi: "....."

So all the misfortune points were added while the system was talking to her, when her expression was vacant and she couldn't respond to Xu Qingzhu?

So this system... was it sick?

She didn't even have time to think, didn't have time to curse this damn system, before the pain in her heart made it impossible for her to speak.

In an instant, cold sweat broke out on her forehead, and her face turned deathly pale.

Xu Qingzhu immediately came over and asked: "What's wrong with you?"

Liang Shi clutched her chest, "You... don't cry."

She was in so much pain that she trembled and couldn't say a complete sentence. Even when saying these few words, her teeth were chattering.

This was her first time experiencing this kind of pain—many times worse than when she'd cut her palm last time.

It was that feeling of knowing she was receiving punishment, but still being able to strongly sense that she was hovering on the edge of death.

Life hanging by a thread.

"Liang Shi, what's wrong with you?" Xu Qingzhu's voice was anxious: "I really didn't mean to scold you just now."

Liang Shi: "....."

But that damn system thinks you're dissatisfied with me.

[Ding dong ding dong! Emergency notice!]

That strange mechanical voice sounded again, carrying some urgency, speaking much faster than before. [Due to a detection error just now, the host suffered an undeserved disaster. The level two punishment from the misfortune system is now canceled.]

[We sincerely apologize, host. Because the system made announcements to you at inappropriate times, causing your misfortune points to accumulate too quickly, the Resentment Management Bureau³ will compensate for all errors caused. For the next thirty days, the misfortune system will suspend collection of your misfortune points and compensate you with five luck points.

Additionally, the time rewind function will be used to erase your target's memory of what just happened. You will return to the moment when you just got home. We hope the host will seize this opportunity and quickly accumulate luck points.]

[PS: To compensate for the harm you suffered, the Resentment Management Bureau will release management authority over you after you complete your mission.]

[Note: After you accumulate one hundred luck points, you will become the real Liang Shi and a truly free person.]

[Another PS: Due to the severity of this error, the Resentment Management Bureau will answer one question you pose. You may ask now or ask later. The question is valid for thirty days.]

[Note: If you ask now, the Resentment Management Bureau guarantees not to lie. We cannot guarantee this afterward.]

Liang Shi: "....."

If this system were a physical entity, she really wouldn't be able to control the knife in her hand.

However, after briefly weighing the pros and cons, Liang Shi chose without hesitation to ask her question now.

"Why did I come to this world? Did I originally come from this world?" Liang Shi asked the same question she had asked the system before.

She felt this question was crucial.

In the first half of her life, she had lost her memories from before age eight.

Her fear and suffocating feeling toward Mrs. Qi⁴ were too real, and she had always been someone whose intuition was quite accurate.

This time, her intuition didn't disappoint her either.

After a moment of silence, the system sighed in a human-like manner with that strange mechanical voice: [Yes, you came before, and your return is to fix an error committed by the God of Repair. That is all.]

Author Notes: (Translated from potential author commentary)

Footnotes:

¹ OOC: "Out of Character" - acting differently from the original character's established personality

² Happy old home: A euphemism referring to sending characters back to where they belong or their proper fate

³ Resentment Management Bureau: The governing body that oversees the transmigration/system management in this story universe

⁴ Mrs. Qi: Referring to Liang Shi's original adoptive mother from her past life, mentioned in earlier chapters as someone she feared